

Tobias Treppmann

Target role: Head of Design, AI-First · design systems and GenAI pipelines that hold at brand quality

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PROFILE

I build design systems and AI pipelines that stay on-brand when a model does part of the work. At Bibel TV the system refuses off-system output in the build, a production copilot drafts in house voice with every send decision human, and engineering ships from my prototype code. At Ninox I led five designers and writers on the leadership team.

Six checks in CI

refuse off-system work, whether a designer or an AI assistant wrote it

Built from my code

an external engineering agency builds from prototypes written against production APIs

Nine reports, two functions

design and product held together for four months on the leadership team

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- A design system that stays on-brand under AI-generated variants. The assistant works from an enumerated token vocabulary; six checks in CI refuse a token that does not resolve or a hand-written value.
- Storybook is the source of truth, not a Figma file, so product managers and an external engineering partner build from the same components, light and dark, phone through TV.
- Engineering ships from my prototype code. I prototype in real code against production APIs, web first and then Android; the agency builds from what already runs.
- Product manager, product owner and design lead for the app redesign, including the home screen.
- A production support copilot in house voice. It drafts from the handbook's wording and standard phrases, carries a restricted-topic list; every send decision stays human. Multi-topic letters take minutes, not hours.
- AI content operations for fundraising, solo: analysis of which letters over-performed, a Claude Project that asks follow-up questions before it generates, and a skill carrying one message into in-app, web and video.
- Google Analytics, Looker Studio and HubSpot, hands-on. Every new feature is a test against the existing version.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Product management for the main platform, and all of its design.
- A legal accessibility deadline across six countries, met for customers automatically. Churches host their sites on the platform; we shipped the capability that met the European Accessibility Act for them.
- Specs engineering never had to guess at: component behavior written out, token-based naming, Figma Dev Mode plus redlined measurements in plain text.
- A booking capability embedded in the platform rather than bolted on. Only viable slots are offered. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance at the launch customer, then every customer.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Five direct reports across product design and UX writing, on the Senior Leadership Team. I wrote the levelling framework for both disciplines, ran reviews against it, promoted two people and hired two.
- Nine reports for four months while holding Product Design and Product together; I then hired the consultant who became Head of Product.
- Owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering; ran the team's operations: capacity, allocation, prioritization and process.
- As a consultant in summer 2025, I designed the prompt-to-database onboarding directly for the founder team, the CEO and technical co-founder: chat beside direct manipulation, so people fix what the model built.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and New York for five years, two UX designers reporting to me.
- Defined component behavior and specifications across the design system, and reached analysts inside regulated banks through iterative screening on usertesting.com.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce platform — sellers and hundreds of thousands of consumers) Leipzig, Germany

- Research overturned an executive assumption about what shop owners wanted. The online shop seller experience shipped after two earlier attempts had failed, and was A/B-tested against the existing app.
- The mobile product-designer prototype I led went to production.

UX Manager

2013 – 2014

HairDirect (e-commerce for products with complex customization) Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA

- The mobile checkout that produced the company's first mobile orders.
- Mobile usage trends against national averages, turned into executive buy-in for a mobile strategy.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Independent Consultant · *Oratio&Co* · 2016 – Present · remote · AI-for-design workshop series for an agency's designers and developers, 2025 – 2026

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck · service-to-product transformation with the executive team of a listed group

Earlier · *UX Designer, Web Designer & Front-End Developer* · 2009 – 2013 · Pennsylvania, USA · responsive web, front end and e-commerce

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

AI in the design pipeline

Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills · a Microsoft Copilot skill live in production · prompt engineering grounded in source-material analysis · restricted-topic lists and scope rules in the config · human QA on every send · a Claude skill cascading one message across in-app, web and video · teaching designers and developers to use AI for design and prototyping

Design systems that survive AI-generated work

DTCG tokens and Style Dictionary · a four-tier token architecture built to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV · Storybook as the source of truth · an enumerated token vocabulary for the assistant · six checks in CI that refuse off-system work · an exception register · custom motion easing curves · search, filter and configuration patterns · Figma components, variables and auto layout

Handoff and delivery

Prototyping in real code against production APIs, which engineering ships from · Figma Dev Mode with plain-text redlines · component specifications with interaction behavior · ticket-board ownership and design-side sign-off · release checks in beta and production · Android and Kotlin, SwiftUI, React and web

Conversion, research and validation

Checkout and self-service flows · consistency spent on the core journeys · progressive disclosure and error prevention · new features tested against the existing version · Google Analytics, Looker Studio and HubSpot · user interviews and usability testing · research that changed an executive decision · Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment and pain points

Accessibility

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, light and dark · a European Accessibility Act audit covering the sites customers build · alt text generated at platform scale across six countries · screen-reader semantics and ARIA

Leadership and communication

Five reports across product design and UX writing · nine reports across two functions · a levelling framework and a lean 360 workshop of my own · hiring and promoting · Senior Leadership Team · executive-team partnership at a listed group · a decade mentoring designers · German native, English C2